

Multiple Choice

1. **Answer:** D

Options: A) James Madison; B) Abraham Lincoln; C) Woodrow Wilson; D) Thomas Jefferson

Note: The phrase "Peace, commerce, and honest friendship with all nations, entangling alliances with none" reflects Thomas Jefferson's vision of foreign policy as articulated in his inaugural address, emphasizing his preference for neutrality and non-interventionism in international affairs.

2. **Answer:** A

Options: A) redrawing congressional district boundaries; B) electing a new state governor; C) evaluating the physical accessibility of polling venues; D) deciding where to construct new elementary schools

Note: Every ten years, following the decennial census, state legislatures are tasked with redrawing congressional district boundaries to reflect changes in population and ensure fair representation.

3. **Answer:** B

Options: A) Commerce; B) Ways and Means; C) Education and the Workforce; D) Resources

Note: The Ways and Means Committee is the primary House committee responsible for tax legislation, making it the most effective platform for a member to influence tax policy.

4. **Answer:** C

Options: A) strengthen the military; B) increase funding for social programs; C) reduce the federal deficit; D) limit the president's ability to conduct foreign policy

Note: The Gramm-Rudman Acts of 1985 and 1987 aimed to enforce mandatory budget cuts and establish deficit reduction targets in order to systematically decrease the federal deficit and promote fiscal responsibility.

5. **Answer:** B

Options: A) All of the world's leading economies were declining due to low growth and inflation; B) The United States could no longer remain a superpower and was in decline; C) The soft power of the United States would allow it to avoid decline; D) The rise of Japan had been exaggerated

Note: Paul Kennedy argued that the combination of economic overstretch and military commitments would lead to the decline of the United States as a superpower, as outlined in his analysis of the historical patterns of great powers throughout history.

True / False

6. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The U.S. Constitution provides a general framework for presidential powers, particularly in Article II, which allows for varied interpretations and has resulted in ongoing debates regarding the extent and limits of those powers.

7. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: A presidential nominee to the Supreme Court must receive a simple majority, which is fifty-one percent, of the Senate votes to be confirmed, as stipulated by the constitutional confirmation process.

8. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is true because these five nations were granted permanent membership on the UN Security Council when it was established in 1945, reflecting their significant roles in World War II and their status as major world powers at the time.

9. **Answer:** False

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) is primarily a military alliance focused on collective defense and security rather than solely on economic issues, which distinguishes it from organizations like the World Trade Organization (WTO) that specifically address economic matters.

10. **Answer:** True

Options: A) True; B) False

Note: The statement is true because Article I, Section 7 of the U.S. Constitution explicitly grants the House of Representatives the exclusive authority to initiate revenue bills, reflecting the framers' intention to ensure that taxation and government spending originate with the body most directly accountable to the electorate.

Long Form Response

11. **Answer:** The relationship between federal and state judiciaries is characterized by a significant degree of autonomy, where each operates within its own jurisdiction and legal framework. However, federal courts play a crucial role in reviewing and adjudicating the constitutionality of decisions made by state courts. This oversight is essential in ensuring that state laws and rulings comply with the U.S. Constitution, particularly in cases involving federal rights and protections. While state courts handle the majority of legal disputes, the federal judiciary serves as a check on state powers, maintaining a balance between federal authority and state sovereignty. This dynamic underscores the importance of the federal judiciary in safeguarding constitutional principles at the state level.

Note: correct because it accurately describes the distinct yet interconnected roles of federal and state judiciaries, emphasizing both their autonomy and the essential function of federal courts in ensuring that state court decisions align with constitutional standards.

12. **Answer:** The Marxist perspective interprets U.S. foreign policy as fundamentally driven by the capitalist need to sustain and expand markets for surplus goods. According to this view, the pursuit of new markets is not merely an economic strategy but a necessity for maintaining capitalist growth and stability. As domestic markets become saturated, U.S. policymakers often seek to penetrate foreign markets to ensure continued profitability for American corporations. This search for new markets can lead to interventions in other nations, justifying military and diplomatic actions as means to secure favorable conditions for American capital. Ultimately, Marxists argue that U.S. foreign policy is shaped by the interests of the capitalist class, prioritizing economic expansion over other considerations, such as human rights or democracy.

Note: correct because it effectively identifies the Marxist perspective's emphasis on capitalism's inherent need for market expansion as a driving force behind U.S. foreign policy, linking economic motivations to broader political actions.